

Wednesday, June 24, 2026

The Day I Started Building Again



I asked for help today. That's the first thing I need to remember.

I woke up to the breakup — raw, fresh, the kind of hurt that makes your chest feel hollow before you even open your eyes. But instead of lying there, I opened a chat and said it out loud: *"I recently was in a breakup and I want to learn new skills to make myself busy."*

GPT gave me six options. AI Automation. CAD Design Upgrade. Programming. Content Creation. Game Development. A 90-Day Transformation Challenge. I picked Option 1 without hesitation — Python, AI Automation, Discord Bots, Business Automation. It matched everything I already was: a VA who knows business workflows, a Python learner, someone who builds things.

He gave me a rule I wrote down: *"Never copy AI-generated code until you can explain what each function does in plain English."* I'm going to follow that.



I spent hours fixing OpenCode. It was giving me a black screen every time I ran it. The cause? It was scanning WindowsApps folder and hitting permission errors. The fix: use a project-based workspace, clear the cache, don't run from C:\Users\RB. Once it worked, I set up my AI-Workspace with an `oc` shortcut. Then I installed VS Code with Python and Pylance.

By the end of it, I had a working development environment. Python basics learned in a single session — variables, loops, functions, files, JSON, datetime. I built a File Logger that timestamps messages and loops until you type "exit," then shows the last three entries. It worked. My first real project in this new chapter.



But then, in the middle of sharing my progress, it hit me.

"I'm really depressed right now. Is Day 1 enough?"

The words came out before I could stop them. *"Am I doing great?"* I asked. I meant with depression. GPT said functioning while depressed is harder than normal progress, and I was still building structure while my brain was fighting itself. That matters.

Then the crying started. I was at my cousin's place, trying to hold it together, failing. The headache came. I hadn't eaten all day. I wanted to drink — just to make it stop. GPT talked me through it. He said alcohol only pauses the pain, it comes back stronger. He gave me the twenty-minute-delay rule. He said depression makes everything feel 3-5 times harder. He said consistency at low emotional cost beats intensity every time.

So I told him everything. The full story.



Her name was Elaine. We met through a Discord server — but not the usual way. My best friend swiped on her first on a dating app. He pursued her, they decided to stay friends, and then he told her about me — about my past heartbreaks. That was supposed to help, I think. Instead it became ammunition.

She and I grew close naturally through that server. Through gaming. Through hours of conversation that turned into something real. We became partners, but we kept it secret from my best friend. When she finally told him, he got angry. He turned the friend group against me. He told her bad things about my past — things I trusted him with.

At first she brushed it off. I met her dad. I met her three kids. I spent her daughter's fourth birthday with them — the little girl kissed me on the cheek and called me daddy. I thought that was the beginning of something. I thought I was becoming part of their lives.

But Elaine started to waver. The rumors got to her. She said she liked my best friend more. She had met one of her past suitors. And eventually, she ended things.

I forgave her. I kept my promise to never hurt her. I was civil.

"She was my endgame. My ride or die."

GPT asked if the deeper wound wasn't losing Elaine, but that someone who knew my history weaponized it. That the people who knew me best believed the worst version of me. I hadn't thought about it that way before.



"I still chose her happiness vs mine."

That's what I said when GPT asked why I forgave her so easily. Because even at the end, I wanted her to be okay more than I wanted to be right.

GPT said something that stopped me: *"The love you gave was not wasted."* The relationship ended, but the sincerity was real. *"The outcome does not erase the sincerity."* The love I gave still counts. It doesn't lose its value just because the other person walked away.

He said something else too: *"Some plans will still bring out the best in me, even if she's the one who brought it out."* The growth was always mine. She just gave it a place to grow.



I cried until I couldn't anymore. Then I slept. When I woke up, the headache was gone. The tears had stopped. I was calmer. Still sad — deeply sad — but the wave had passed.

I ate. Lucky Me Pancit Canton. My first real food all day.

I showed up for my night shift at 11 PM. GPT recommended a K-drama — Hospital Playlist. Warm, comforting, friendships. I tried watching but couldn't focus. Sitting here now, typing this, working through my tasks. The grief is still here. It's sitting quietly in the corner of the room, not screaming anymore. GPT was right: *"Healing isn't a straight line. It's waves."*



I told GPT about the words I said to Elaine every day during our 15 days together. "I am here. I am real. I won't go anywhere." I said them to reassure her, to promise her I'd never leave.

GPT was quiet for a moment. Then he said those words don't only belong to her anymore. They belong to me now.

I wrote them down tonight.

"I am here." — I'm still here, after everything.

"I am real." — My love was real. My effort was real. My grief is real.

"I won't go anywhere." — I won't abandon myself the way others have left.



The Songs

Gusto Ko Sakin Ka Lang — Elaine used to tease me with this song. It made my heart flutter every time. I don't know if I can listen to it the same way now.

Eagles — I played their music during the worst of the emotional wave. It helped calm me down.



The Friends

My cousin was there in the room, but I couldn't bring myself to talk. I sat there holding it in while my chest was breaking. GPT told me it's okay to say *"I'm not okay right now. I just need company."* I didn't say it tonight. But maybe next time I will.



Closing

Day 1 was survival. Pure and simple. I didn't build anything impressive. I didn't make a breakthrough. I just made it through.

But I did a few things right: - I asked for help instead of isolating. - I learned Python basics and built my first project. - I fixed a technical problem instead of giving up on it. - I told someone the full story instead of bottling it. - I ate when I didn't want to. - I showed up for work. - I didn't drink.

I'm still here. And tonight, that's enough.

Tomorrow is Day 2. I don't know what it will bring. But I'll be here for it.

